

Elbit as Cross-System Load-Bearing Node - Research Checkpoint Pack

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Status: Research notes for writer / briefing use. Not legal advice.

Scope: Public-domain sourcing plus clearly labelled analysis developed from the conversation.

1. Executive thesis

- **Core working thesis:** Elbit Systems is useful as a bridge-point case study because the same corporate name carries different legal, strategic, economic and symbolic weight across different jurisdictions.
- **Safer phrasing:** Elbit may be a *cross-system load-bearing node* rather than a single uniform object.
- **Even safer phrasing:** Elbit can be analysed as a *defence-sector stress case* showing how modern defence, tech, procurement, protest and international-law systems behave under prolonged atrocity-risk conditions.
- **Do not overclaim:** The public sources do not prove that any state is protecting Elbit because of one named contract, nor do they prove corrupt coordination. They do support the more careful claim that Elbit is materially embedded in several allied defence ecosystems.
- **Writing north star:** The present aim is not to settle every ideological question about Israel/Palestine, Zionism, anti-Zionism, defence procurement or direct action. The immediate legal/humanitarian anchor is the ICJ provisional-measures framework and the protection of Palestinians from genocide-risk and related prohibited acts. [S1-S5]

2. Public-domain factual anchors

2.1 ICJ / Genocide Convention anchor

- The ICJ case is **Application of the Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide in the Gaza Strip (South Africa v. Israel)**. [S1]
- On **26 January 2024**, the ICJ issued provisional measures. The order did not make a final genocide finding. It did find that at least some rights claimed under the Genocide Convention were plausible and ordered measures including prevention of Article II acts, prevention and punishment of direct/public incitement, humanitarian assistance, evidence preservation and reporting. [S2]
- On **28 March 2024**, the ICJ issued further provisional measures / modifications connected to deteriorating humanitarian conditions. [S3]
- On **24 May 2024**, the ICJ reaffirmed earlier measures and issued further measures concerning Rafah and humanitarian access. [S4, S10]
- The Genocide Convention requires prevention and punishment; Article III also includes complicity, attempt and direct/public incitement, and Article IV applies to constitutionally responsible rulers, public officials and private individuals. [S5]
- Research note: for briefing purposes, use “ICJ provisional measures / genocide-risk legal atmosphere” rather than “ICJ proved genocide” unless discussing later legal findings from a separately sourced body.

2.2 Elbit corporate / macroeconomic anchor

- Elbit reported **\$7.9386bn revenue for 2025** and **\$28.1bn order backlog at 31 Dec 2025**. About 72% of backlog was attributable to orders from outside Israel. [S11]
- Reuters reported on **26 May 2026** that Elbit Q1 2026 revenue rose to about **\$2.2bn** and backlog reached **\$30.2bn**, with 71% of orders from outside Israel. [S12]
- Reuters reported Israel defence exports reached nearly **\$15bn in 2024**, up 13%, with Europe accounting for 54% and the US 9%. [S13]
- The Bank of Israel Annual Report 2025 describes a fiscal environment shaped by high defence expenditure, debt/deficit management and measures aimed at market confidence. [S14]
- Analytical implication: Elbit is not only a defence company; in Israel's wider economic frame it sits inside a defence-export and war-economy ecosystem with macroeconomic relevance. Treat that as structural context, not a claim that the Bank of Israel directs corporate decisions. [S11-S14]

3. Jurisdiction-specific load-bearing profiles

3.1 Israel: domestic strategic infrastructure

- Public sources identify Elbit as Israel's largest defence company and a major exporter; company financials and Reuters reporting show a very large backlog and significant international demand. [S11-S13]
- The Israel profile is the most direct: defence-industrial capacity, wartime production, skilled employment, export revenue, military-tech development and domestic strategic capability.
- For Israel, harm to Elbit can plausibly be framed by state/security actors as harm to defence readiness, wartime production and strategic export capacity.
- Analytical caution: "load-bearing" here does not mean Elbit is the only load-bearing defence actor. Rafael, Israel Aerospace Industries and other firms also matter. Elbit is the useful bridge-point case because it is visible, transnational and repeatedly targeted in public activism.

3.2 UK: visible programme/site contractor and protest flashpoint

- A UK government FOI response states that Thales UK was prime contractor for Watchkeeper and that UAV Tactical Systems Ltd., an Elbit/Thales joint venture, supplied the Watchkeeper air vehicle under subcontract. [S15]
- Watchkeeper is a UK drone/ISTAR case that made Elbit comparatively publicly legible in the UK as a UAV-related actor. [S15-S17]
- Later reporting describes Watchkeeper as troubled and slated for early retirement, with subsequent reporting indicating service extension to March 2027. [S16-S17]
- Public-order/legal-risk context: UK prosecutions connected to actions at Elbit sites are in the public domain. Reuters reported February 2026 acquittals on aggravated burglary and other outcomes, then May 2026 criminal-damage convictions for four activists in relation to a 2024 Elbit facility raid. [S31-S32]
- The UK government also announced the proscription of Palestine Action under the Terrorism Act 2000; that official source should be cited as the government's position, while critiques should be separately sourced if used. [S30]
- Analytical implication: the UK profile is highly visible because company/site/protest/procurement narratives collide in one public space. The risk calculation is not only "brand reputation" but also defence procurement, site security, public order, protest law and state credibility.

3.3 US: distributed subsystem supplier, not one obvious drone programme

- Pre-2026 public sources show Elbit America embedded in US Army/USAF capability areas: mortar fire-control, mortar systems, F-16 missile warning and F-16 head-up display replacement. [S18-S23]
- In 2017 Elbit America announced a US Army ID/IQ contract up to **\$102m** for mortar fire-control systems; Reuters independently reported the deal. [S18-S19]
- In 2022 Elbit Systems announced an approximately **\$49m** ID/IQ contract for 120mm mortar systems for the US Army. [S20]
- In 2020 Elbit America announced a US Air Force contract to supply pylon-based infrared missile-warning systems for F-16s; the wider reported ceiling was **\$471.6m**. [S21]
- In 2024 Elbit America announced a USAF F-16 Block 40/42 Wide-Angle Conventional Head-Up Display replacement ID/IQ ceiling up to **\$89m**, with a first delivery order over **\$57.5m**. [S23]
- In December 2025 a US government contract notice listed **\$49.9m** for Elbit America Heads Up displays with estimated completion in 2030. [S22]
- Post-2026 culmination: the Soldier Borne Mission Command award and next-generation binocular night vision are strong evidence of the direction of travel into battlefield-awareness/soldier-systems architecture, but they should not be used as pre-2026 evidence. [S24-S25]
- Analytical implication: the US load-bearing profile is **distributed**: soldier systems, vision, displays, platform survivability, fire control and C2-adjacent technologies. It is less like the UK Watchkeeper story and more like an embedded supplier/subsystem mesh.

3.4 Germany: rearmament / NATO-readiness partner profile

- Elbit Systems Germany publicly describes Bundeswehr-relevant work in drone defence, communication, C2, reconnaissance and target designation, with E-LynX radios produced in Ulm for the DLBO digitisation programme and already in Bundeswehr use. [S26]
- Elbit announced a **\$260m** contract to supply DIRCM self-protection systems for Germany's A400M fleet. [S27]
- Reuters reported Lufthansa Technik would work with Elbit on a German Navy Hermes 900 Starliner military drone project, with Lufthansa Technik handling maintenance/training and Elbit producing drones; the project sits in Germany's post-2022 defence-spending environment. [S28]
- Reuters also reported wider European demand for Elbit PULS/advanced rocket systems. [S29]
- Analytical implication: Germany's profile is shaped by Bundeswehr modernisation, NATO readiness, aircraft self-protection, soldier radios, drone capabilities, long-range fires and Germany's distinct Israel-policy/legal-memory environment.

4. Cross-system analysis from the conversation

4.1 “Jurisdictionally polymorphic” company object

- The same company can be viewed differently depending on who is looking:
 - Israel: domestic defence-industrial infrastructure.
 - UK: visible foreign-linked contractor and public-order flashpoint.
 - US: US subsidiary embedded across multiple capability stacks.
 - Germany: supplier inside accelerated rearmament and NATO-readiness architecture.
 - Public activists: symbol of Israeli military technology and alleged complicity.
 - Investors/banks/insurers: financial, legal, reputational and continuity risk.
- Research use: this framing explains why apparently similar Western democracies may respond differently to protest/divestment/procurement scrutiny.

4.2 Compliance architecture can become containment architecture

- Defence procurement is often opaque for ordinary reasons: classification, export controls, security, commercial confidentiality, sensitive technology and sovereign procurement discretion.
- Under normal conditions, subsidiaries, local counsel, compliance teams and procurement segmentation can be read as strong governance design.
- Under post-October 2023 / ICJ-provisional-measures conditions, the same structures can appear to the public as opacity, exceptionalism, special treatment or accountability avoidance.
- Research use: this lets the writer avoid an over-simple “conspiracy” frame while still explaining why public suspicion is rationally produced.

4.3 Competent silos can still produce global under-modelling

- Each jurisdiction can reasonably model its own legal risk and avoid pretending to be expert in another jurisdiction.
- That is competent professional boundary-keeping, not inherently evasive.
- But when the issue crosses international humanitarian law, genocide-prevention duties, defence procurement, corporate governance, investor risk, protest law and diaspora grief, no single silo fully owns the climate system.
- Strong line for later drafting: **Each node models its own legal weather; nobody fully owns the climate system.**

4.4 Why Elbit becomes a “precedent-risk” object

- Elbit is not necessarily the only company with this profile. It is a conspicuous stress case.
- If legal theories, divestment campaigns, protest defences, procurement reviews or reputational pressure succeed against Elbit, other defence-tech, AI, surveillance, battlefield-awareness and dual-use firms may read the case as precedent risk for themselves.
- This could produce defensive behaviour from adjacent sectors without requiring a single coordinated conspiracy.
- Strong line: **Elbit may become the condensation point for wider defence-tech panic.**

4.5 Why the public reads opacity as authoritarian drift

- European publics bring multiple twentieth-century and colonial memory stacks to the field: fascism, collaboration, occupation, colonial violence, Algeria, Ireland, the Balkans, the Holocaust, Cold War securitisation, Berlin Wall memory, emergency powers, counterterrorism after 9/11, Iraq, Afghanistan and migration securitisation.
- Israeli and North American institutions may read European protest through other alarms: antisemitism risk, October 7 trauma, hostage grief, national security, anti-Israel mobilisation, foreign interference or extremism.
- The result is mutual misread: each party sees its own inherited catastrophe clearly and the other party's catastrophe as exaggerated, manipulative or hostile.

5. Legal/humanitarian discipline for later writing

5.1 Main harm first

- The briefing's centre of gravity should be explicit: protection of Palestinians under current atrocity-risk conditions and practical upholding of the ICJ provisional measures. [S1-S5]
- This does not require ideological closure on Israel's long-term constitutional future, anti-Zionism/Zionism, statehood models, reparations, return, security architecture or decolonial theory.
- It does require tactical discipline: do not let every adjacent legal/procurement/reputational side-front consume the anti-genocide objective.
- Strong line: **No genocide prevention while everyone is busy defending their own side-quest.**

5.2 De-escalation is not neutrality

- De-escalation here means lowering the ambient threat level so people and institutions can remain legally, morally and cognitively competent.
- It does not mean abandoning accountability, erasing Palestinian harm, abandoning Israeli hostage families, ignoring antisemitism, ignoring anti-Muslim racism or pretending defence infrastructure is apolitical.
- Strong line: **De-escalation is not moral neutrality; it is the precondition for lawful judgment and practical protection.**

5.3 Humanisation without exoneration

- ICRC sources support the proposition that dehumanization increases conflict and abuse risk and makes legal protections easier to set aside. [S7-S8]
- Therefore, refusing dehumanisation is not sentimental niceness. It is anti-escalation infrastructure.
- Humanisation does not require exoneration: a person, company, official, activist or soldier can be human and still legally or morally accountable.
- Strong line: **Rehumanisation is not absolution. It is anti-escalation infrastructure.**

5.4 Universal humanity; unequal exposure

- A careful note must not collapse power asymmetry. Palestinians in Gaza, the West Bank and East Jerusalem face a different order of immediate material danger than most diaspora actors or corporate/state actors.
- Better framing: many groups carry real historical fear and present insecurity, but they are not equally situated and do not wield equal coercive power.
- Strong line: **Universal humanity; unequal exposure.**

6. Strategic notes for a writer

6.1 What the writer can safely say

- Elbit is materially embedded in multiple defence ecosystems, but differently in each jurisdiction.
- Public procurement and corporate sources support a “distributed load-bearing” analysis in the US and a “visible programme/site contractor” analysis in the UK.
- German public sources support a Bundeswehr-modernisation/NATO-readiness profile involving radios, aircraft protection and drone-related work.
- Israeli financial/export sources support a macroeconomic/defence-export relevance frame.
- The ICJ orders create a concrete legal anchor for atrocity-risk and preventive-measures discussion.
- Modern defence compliance architecture can be strong in normal conditions and still fail to manage cross-jurisdictional atrocity-risk perception.

6.2 What the writer should not say without more evidence

- Do not say Elbit is the single reason states are policing protests in a particular way.
- Do not say all Western defence/tech firms are secretly coordinating to protect Elbit.
- Do not say the ICJ has made a final finding that Israel committed genocide unless using a later, specific source that says so and clearly distinguishes it from the ICJ merits case.
- Do not say all activists are irrational or all institutional responses are purely neutral.
- Do not say all affected groups are equally oppressed. Use “universal humanity; unequal exposure.”

- Do not use loose “8200 network everywhere” language. Use “dense military, intelligence, cyber and private-sector crossover in Israel's defence-tech ecosystem” only if later sourced.

6.3 Low-cost de-escalation measures worth developing later

- Public-facing explanation of what can/cannot be disclosed in defence procurement, with plain-English reasons.
- Independent review channels for arms/export/procurement risk that do not require citizens to infer everything from silence.
- Human-rights due-diligence escalation routes for companies in conflict-affected contexts. [S9]
- Community safety language that recognises antisemitism, anti-Muslim racism and Palestinian material exposure without treating them as interchangeable.
- Tactical discipline for activists: separate expressive action from effective harm-reduction action.
- Tactical discipline for institutions: avoid converting ordinary moral alarm into security threat language unless the facts truly require it.
- Rehumanisation protocols: prohibit exterminatory/dehumanising language across all sides while preserving accountability language.

7. Suggested series architecture

1. Elbit as Cross-System Load-Bearing Node

Public-domain contracts, jurisdictions, and why one company becomes a bridge-point case.

2. When Local Compliance Cannot Model Global Consequence

How competent legal silos become insufficient under atrocity-risk and internet-era public scrutiny.

3. When Compliance Architecture Becomes Containment Architecture

Why normal defence opacity becomes publicly legible as impunity.

4. When One Company Becomes the Precedent Risk

Why adjacent defence-tech firms may read Elbit pressure as their own future risk model.

5. Universal Humanity; Unequal Exposure

A de-escalation ethic that humanises everyone without flattening Palestinian material danger.

6. Do Not Confuse Expression With Effect

Activist strategy under burnout: keeping anti-genocide work calibrated to actual protection.

7. De-escalation as Anti-Atrocity Infrastructure

Practical, low-cost measures that reduce threat level while preserving accountability and ICJ-focused prevention.

8. Source ledger

ID	Source	Plain-English use	URL
S1	International Court of Justice case page for South Africa v. Israel	Official docket for the Genocide Convention case concerning Gaza; use as the anchor for procedural history and orders.	https://www.icj-cij.org/case/192
S2	ICJ Order of 26 January 2024	Official provisional-measures order. Supports claims that the ICJ found plausible rights under the Genocide Convention and ordered Israel to prevent prohibited acts, prevent and punish incitement, enable humanitarian assistance, preserve evidence, and report.	https://www.icj-cij.org/node/203447
S3	ICJ Order of 28 March 2024	Official further provisional-measures order modifying/adding to the January framework in response to deteriorating humanitarian conditions.	https://www.icj-cij.org/node/203847

ID	Source	Plain-English use	URL
S4	ICJ Order of 24 May 2024	Official order on Rafah and humanitarian access; supports the claim that the ICJ reaffirmed earlier measures and added further requirements.	https://www.icj-cij.org/node/204091
S5	OHCHR text of the Genocide Convention	Primary treaty text. Use for Articles I, III, IV, V and the prevention/punishment framework.	https://www.ohchr.org/en/instruments-mechanisms/instruments/convention-prevention-and-punishment-crime-genocide
S6	UN Audiovisual Library note on the Genocide Convention	Useful plain-English legal background on Article I and the prevention/punishment pairing.	https://legal.un.org/avl/ha/cppcg/cppcg.html
S7	ICRC - De-dehumanization: Practicing humanity	Supports the de-escalation/humanisation point: dehumanization increases conflict and abuse risk and makes conflict harder to resolve.	https://international-review.icrc.org/articles/de-dehumanization-practicing-humanity-925
S8	ICRC - Respect for IHL supports fundamental human rights	Supports the point that dehumanizing narratives make legal protections easier to set aside and harm easier to justify.	https://www.icrc.org/en/statement/respect-ihl-supports-fundamental-human-rights-most-extreme-circumstances
S9	UNDP/UN Working Group guide on heightened human-rights due diligence	Business-and-human-rights source for companies in conflict-affected contexts; useful for the corporate-risk/due-diligence layer.	https://www.undp.org/sites/g/files/zskgke326/files/2022-06/UNDP_Heightened_Human_Rights_Due_Diligence_for_Business_in_Conflict-Affected_Context.pdf
S10	Reuters - ICJ ruling of 24 May 2024	Secondary source summary of the May 2024 ICJ order; useful for fast reader orientation but not a substitute for the official order.	https://www.reuters.com/world/international-court-justice-ruling-israels-actions-gaza-2024-05-24/
S11	Elbit Systems 2025 full-year results	Company source for revenue, backlog, geographic order mix and global footprint in 2025.	https://www.elbitsystems.com/sites/default/files/2026-03/17032026e.pdf
S12	Reuters - Elbit Q1 2026 results	Current source for Q1 2026 revenue/backlog and the 71% outside-Israel order backlog figure.	https://www.reuters.com/world/middle-east/israeli-defence-firm-elbit-systems-profit-revenue-jump-2026-05-26/
S13	Reuters - Israel defence exports 2024	Macro source for Israel defence exports reaching nearly \$15bn in 2024 and Europe taking a major share.	https://www.reuters.com/world/middle-east/amid-gaza-war-israel-defence-exports-jump-13-2024-record-15-bln-2025-06-04/
S14	Bank of Israel Annual Report 2025	Macroeconomic source for Israel's war/defence-spending context, deficit, debt and market-confidence framing.	https://www.boi.org.il/en/communication-and-publications/regular-publications/bank-of-israel-annual-report/bank-of-israel-annual-report-2025-1/
S15	UK Government FOI response on Watchkeeper/Elbit	Public UK source stating Thales was prime contractor and UAV Tactical Systems Ltd., an Elbit/Thales joint venture, supplied the Watchkeeper air vehicle under subcontract.	https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/5a7d9706ed915d497af70573/20130723-RFI_144550-013_Response_final_Redacted.pdf
S16	FlightGlobal - Watchkeeper early retirement	Secondary defence-industry source on the UK decision to retire Watchkeeper early and the troubled programme context.	https://www.flightglobal.com/military-uavs/2024/11/why-uks-watchkeeper-uav-failed-the-test-of-time/160917.article

ID	Source	Plain-English use	URL
S17	AeroTime - Watchkeeper extension to 2027	Secondary source reporting the extension of Watchkeeper service to March 2027, overlapping replacement plans.	https://www.aerotime.aero/articles/uk-delays-watchkeeper-drone-retirement
S18	Elbit America - \$102m US Army mortar fire-control ID/IQ	US subsidiary source for Elbit America supplying and fielding mortar fire-control systems for the US Army; useful as pre-2026 battlefield-systems evidence.	https://www.elbitamerica.com/news/elbit-systems-of-america-receives-102m-id/iq-contract-for-the-supply-of-mortar-fire-control-systems-to-the-u.s.-army
S19	Reuters - Elbit \$102m US Army mortar fire-control deal	Independent source on the 2017 US Army mortar fire-control systems deal.	https://www.reuters.com/article/world/elbit-systems-wins-102-million-u-s-army-mortar-fire-systems-deal-idUSKBN15V0YM/
S20	Elbit Systems - \$49m US Army 120mm mortar systems	Company source for the 2022 five-year US Army mortar-systems ID/IQ award.	https://www.elbitsystems.com/news/elbit-systems-america-awarded-49-million-id/q-contract-supply-mortar-systems-us-army

ID	Source	Plain-English use	URL
S21	Elbit Systems - US Air Force F-16 missile-warning contract	Company source for the 2020 F-16 pylon-based infrared missile-warning-system contract; includes initial order and contract structure.	https://www.elbitsystems.com/news/elbit-systems-america-awarded-us-air-force-contract-supply-missile-warning-systems
S22	DoD contracts - 22 Dec 2025, Elbit America Heads Up displays	US government contract notice for \$49.9m Heads Up display contract, estimated completion Dec. 2030.	https://www.war.gov/News/Contracts/Contract/Article/4366669/
S23	Elbit America - F-16 head-up display replacement	Company source for 2024 USAF F-16 Block 40/42 WACHUD ID/IQ contract up to \$89m, first delivery order over \$57.5m.	https://www.elbitamerica.com/news/elbit-america-to-provide-modernized-head-up-display-replacement-for-f-16-community
S24	Elbit Systems - Soldier Borne Mission Command	Company source for March 2026 \$120.5m OTA award for Soldier Borne Mission Command; use as post-2026 culmination, not pre-2026 evidence.	https://www.elbitsystems.com/news/elbit-america-awarded-us-army-contract-establish-new-class-soldier-capability
S25	Elbit America - next-generation binocular night-vision systems	Company source for 2026 US Army BNOD pathway and night-vision/soldier-systems continuity.	https://www.elbitamerica.com/news/elbit-america-wins-u.s.-army-contract-to-deliver-next-generation-binocular-night-vision-systems
S26	Elbit Systems Germany - Enforce Tac 2024	German subsidiary source describing Bundeswehr-use radios, Ulm production for DLBO, C2/drone-defence/reconnaissance/targeting portfolio.	https://elbitsystems-de.com/en/elbit-systems-germany-enforce-tac-2024-high-tech-for-the-european-market/
S27	Elbit Systems - Germany A400M DIRCM \$260m	Company source for 2025 DIRCM self-protection contract for Germany's A400M fleet.	https://www.elbitsystems.com/news/elbit-systems-awarded-260-million-contract-supply-dircm-self-protection-systems-germanys-a400m
S28	Reuters - Lufthansa Technik/Elbit German Navy Hermes 900 project	Independent source on Lufthansa Technik working with Elbit on military drones for the German Navy; useful for German drone-dependency profile.	https://www.reuters.com/business/aerospace-defense/lufthansa-technik-work-with-israelis-elbit-military-drones-2024-05-06/
S29	Reuters - Elbit European rocket supply deal	Secondary source on PULS/advanced rocket-system demand in Europe; useful for the wider European long-range-fires context.	https://www.reuters.com/business/aerospace-defense/israeli-defence-firm-elbit-gets-130-million-european-rocket-supply-deal-2025-04-01/
S30	UK Government - three groups to be proscribed	Official government position on Palestine Action proscription under the Terrorism Act 2000; use carefully and distinguish from criticism of that move.	https://www.gov.uk/government/news/three-groups-to-be-proscribed
S31	Reuters - UK Elbit criminal-damage convictions, May 2026	Independent current source on criminal-damage convictions connected to an Elbit Systems UK facility; useful for the public-order/legal-risk layer.	https://www.reuters.com/world/four-uk-pro-palestinian-activists-guilty-criminal-damage-over-raid-israeli-firm-2026-05-05/
S32	Reuters - UK activists not guilty of aggravated burglary, Feb 2026	Independent source showing complexity of criminal charges, acquittals and hung counts in the same litigation stream.	https://www.reuters.com/business/aerospace-defense/uk-pro-palestinian-activists-not-guilty-aggravated-burglary-israeli-firms-2026-02-04/